Halden Warehouse Operations

Receiving goods

Every inbound pallet is scanned at dock door before the driver signs the delivery note. The receiving clerk compares the count with the advance shipping notice and records any difference in the discrepancy log within 45 minutes of unloading. Damaged cartons stay on the quarantine rack until a supervisor has inspected them and released them for putaway.

Cold storage

Frozen goods are held in chamber four, where the setpoint is minus 23 degrees Celsius. The building management system raises an alarm when a door stays open for longer than ninety seconds, and the shift lead must then walk the chamber and sign the temperature sheet.

Equipment and site safety

Forklift drivers renew their operating licence every 18 months at the Tromsdal training centre. The course includes a written paper and a practical assessment in a marked yard. A driver whose licence has lapsed is moved to manual picking until the renewal is complete, and the transport office removes the driver badge from the truck access system.

Racking inspections are the responsibility of the facilities engineer, who walks every aisle on the first Tuesday of each quarter. Bent uprights are tagged in red and the bay is unloaded the same day. Repairs use only parts from the original manufacturer, because mixed components void the load rating printed on the end of each aisle.

Hearing protection is compulsory in the conveyor hall, where sound levels measured last spring reached 88 decibels near the sorter. Visitors collect disposable ear plugs from the dispenser at the hall entrance.

Employees with moulded plugs have them tested once a year by the occupational health nurse who visits the site.

Fire doors between the mezzanine and the packing area close automatically when the alarm panel triggers. Staff assemble at muster point Kestrel, on the far side of the employee car park, and team leaders count their people against the electronic roll call on the shared tablet. Nobody goes back inside until the fire warden has given the all clear.

Battery charging takes place in a ventilated bay behind gate seven. Lead acid batteries need a cooling period of six hours after a full charge before they go back in a truck, and the charging log records the serial number of each unit. Spilled electrolyte is neutralised with the soda ash kept in the yellow bin beside the eyewash station.

Picking and dispatch

Pickers follow the route shown on the wrist scanner, which groups orders into waves of up to forty lines. Fragile lines are always picked last, so that nothing heavy is placed on top of them in the tote. A picker who cannot find an item reports a short pick and the scanner sends the task to the inventory controller.

The final dispatch cut-off for next day delivery is 17:40 on working days. Parcels that miss this time are held on the overflow lane and leave on the early morning trunk vehicle. During the peak season the transport planner may publish a later time on the dispatch notice board.

Returned parcels arrive at bay twelve and are graded by the returns team. Grade C stock is sold to the liquidation partner Morvik Traders at the end of each month, while grade A stock goes straight back into its original location. Items with a broken seal are never returned to saleable

stock, whatever their outward condition.